Welcome to LUG!



Please check in: sh.lug.umbc.edu/checkin

Distro Speed Dating

Find your perfect Linux Match

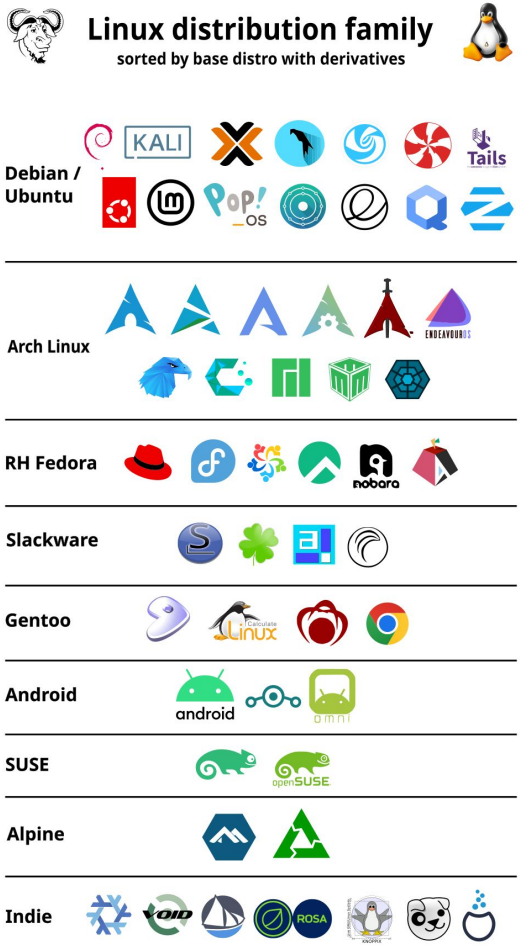
What is a Linux Distribution?

- Linux on it's own isn't a full Operating System
- A distro is a complete Operating System built on the Linux Kernel
  - Includes a maintained bundle of software that turns the Linux Kernel into a fully usable system.
- Key Components
  - The Kernel
  - Desktop Environment
  - Package Manager
  - Init System
  - Pre-Installed Software



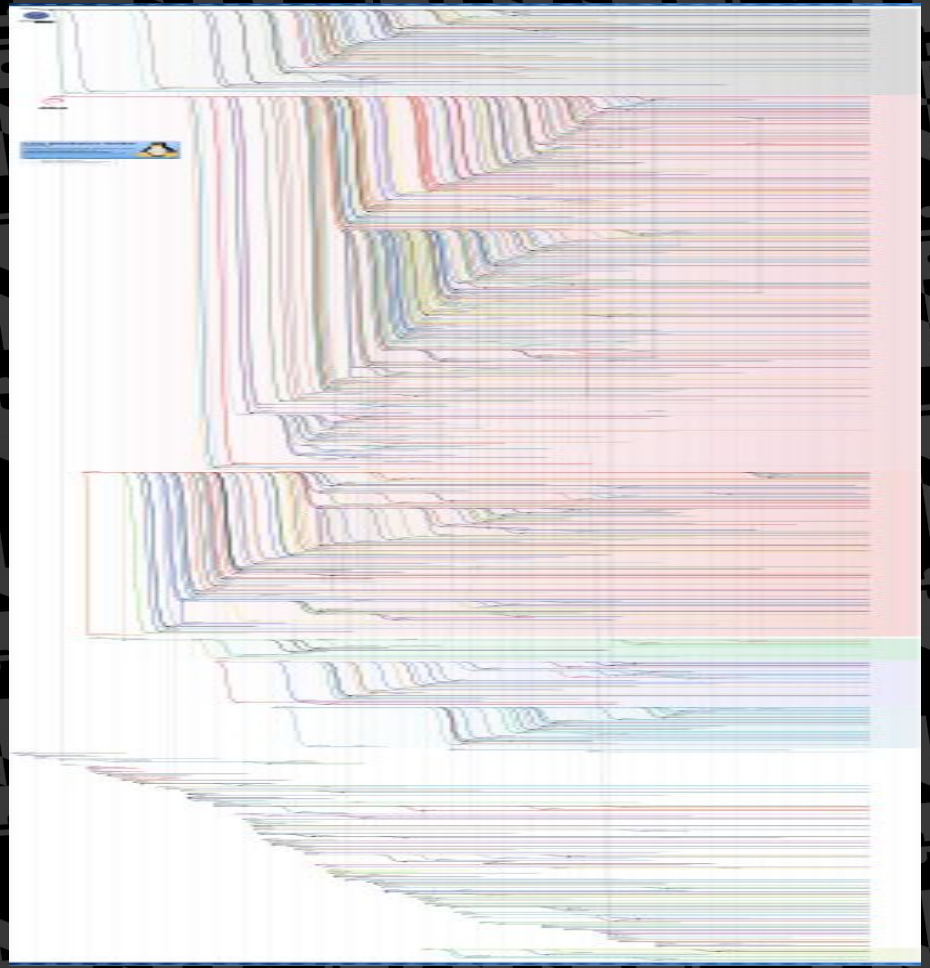
Linux Distribution Hierarchy

- Most Linux Distribution can be sorted into families.
- Base / Parent Distributions
  - Debian, Arch, and Fedora
- Child Distributions
  - Debian > Ubuntu > Linux Mint
- Independent projects
  - Void, NixOS, Puppy, etc…



Wikipedia Linux Distribution Timeline

Link



Choosing a Distro

Choosing a distro is difficult

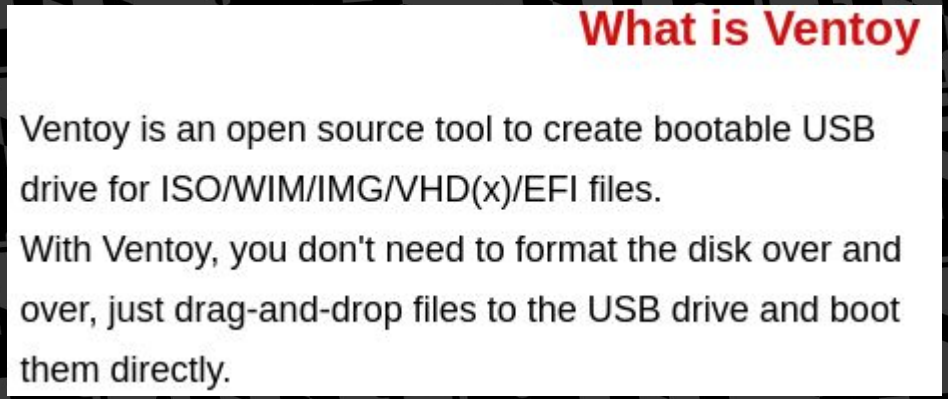
Define your needs/wants and explore what has those features

Ask yourself:

- What's my use case?
  - Development, Productivity, Gaming, Coursework, etc…
- What desktop environment do I want?
  - Familiarity, Performance, Efficiency?
- What software do I need to run?

Introducing Ventoy





- Ventoy makes it easy to try lots of distros on your system
- Try out “live” environments
- Allows you to boot to a USB and select a downloaded distro to try out

Ventoy Live USB Showcase

The Distros in question

- Linux Mint (Cinnamon)
  - User Friendly, great for “Windows Refugees”
- Debian XFCE
  - Lightweight, simple
- CachyOS
  - Gaming Focused, extremely customizable
- Fedora KDE Plasma
  - Strong well-rounded desktop experience
- Tails
  - Privacy focused, Temporary

What now?

Convinced? Install Linux if you haven't already

Hold on to the USB for:

- Great for distro hopping
- Pocket OS
- Emergency recovery kit

